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■ A Palestinian girl stands amid the rubble of the Al Aimawi family's home that was destroyed by Israeli airstrikes in Al Zawaideh, Gaza Strip, on Tuesday.

Trump says Israel agreed on terms for a 60-day Gaza truce

Hamas open to ceasefire but seeks end to war as deal expected next week

WASHINGTON

Hamas suggested yesterday that it was open to a ceasefire agreement with Israel, but stopped short of accepting a US-backed proposal announced by US President Donald Trump hours earlier, insisting on its long-standing position that any deal bring an end to the war in Gaza.

Trump said Tuesday that Israel had agreed on terms for a 60-day ceasefire in Gaza and urged Hamas to accept the deal before conditions worsen. The US leader has been increasing pressure on the Israeli government and Hamas to broker a ceasefire, and hostage agreement and bring about an end to the war.

Trump said the 60-day period would be used to work toward ending the war — something Israel says it won't accept until Hamas is defeated. He said

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that a deal might come together as soon as next week.

But Hamas' response, which emphasised its demand that the war end, raised questions about whether the latest offer could materialise into an actual pause in fighting.

'Ready and serious'

Hamas official Taher Al Nunu said that the militant group was "ready and serious regarding reaching an agreement."

He said Hamas was "ready to accept any initiative that clearly leads to the complete end to the war." A Hamas delegation was expected to meet with Egyptian and Qatari mediators in Cairo yesterday to discuss the proposal, according to an Egyptian official.

An Israeli official said that the

latest proposal calls for a 60-day deal that would include a partial Israeli withdrawal from Gaza and a surge in humanitarian aid to the territory. The mediators and the US would provide assurances about talks on an end to the war, but Israel isn't committing to that as part of the latest proposal, the official said.

It wasn't clear how many hostages would be freed as part of the agreement, but previous proposals have called for the release of about 10.

Israel has yet to publicly comment on Trump's announcement. Trump is set to host Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu for talks at the White House next Monday.

On Tuesday, Trump wrote on social media that Israel had "agreed to the necessary conditions to finalise the 60-day ceasefire, during which time we will work with all parties to end the War."

"I hope, for the good of the Middle East, that Hamas takes this deal, because it will not get better — it will only get worse," he said.

— AP

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Woman pays off \$12,000 credit card debt using AI

Allan shares repayment journey on TikTok

DUBAI

BY NISHITHA RACHEL
Assistant Social Media Editor

A woman in the US used AI to help her clear her debt — and it worked! Jennifer Allan, 35, a realtor and content creator from Delaware was desperate to pay off her \$23,000 (Dh84,467.50) credit card debt, when she realised she could use AI's help to change her habits.

Allan began her 30-day challenge on TikTok, where she decided to use ChatGPT every day for 30 days, to help pay off her debt. ChatGPT suggested different ways for Allan to save or earn money. It included cancelling sub-



scriptions she didn't need, selling items on Facebook marketplace, filing for unclaimed money and more.

Allan also discovered a brokerage account she wasn't aware she had, and finance apps the AI suggested she look through, which helped her find more than \$10,000. On June 19, Allan had paid off \$12,078.93. She hopes to pay off the remaining debt during the new ongoing 30-day challenge.

Dubai launches scheme for new home buyers

PROPERTIES BELOW DH5M ELIGIBLE UNDER NEW INITIATIVE

DUBAI

BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Dubai has launched a new initiative to enable residents in the UAE to own their first homes in the emirate. Those signing up will get 'preferential pricing and access to new launches', along with more accessible mortgage support.

The properties have to be under Dh5 million to be eligible for the preferential treatment. These home owners will get to have one of the lowest financing rates to buy the properties.

Mortgage tenors will extend up to 18 years. The properties available through the programme will have 'better rates than what's available in the market'.

For both locals and expats

The target is to get 'both locals and expats to own a home', said Majid Al Marri, CEO of Real Estate Registration Sector at Dubai Land Department (DLD). "In a second phase, we could open this programme to overseas buyers."

Dubai property recorded

WHO CAN BENEFIT?

- Every UAE national and resident can qualify for the programme.
- They must not own a home earlier in the country.
- They must be over 18 years.

110,000 new property investors, based on its latest data. It's up to the banks involved to decide what salary levels are eligible for the potential owners.

The 'own a first home' initiative brings together DLD and Dubai Department of Economy & Tourism. Buyers who sign up for the programme will get flexible payment plans from banks participating in the project as well as support from developers.

So far, 13 developers and 5 banks have signed up to offer the preferential terms to home buyers wanting to go through the programme. It's a given that more developers will sign up for this, offering as it does another avenue for them to find buyers.

The likes of online property platforms Bayut, Property Finder

and dubizzle as well as brokers have signed up.

Investors can sign up through the DLD website or through the Dubai REST app. The intent is to convince those potential investors who feel they should wait longer for the Dubai property market prices to cool off. This is where the flexible payment options — over and above what's available in the market from developers — could pay off for the new launch.

Turning dream into reality

"We are taking this step to make the dream of owning a home reality," said a top official from Dubai Department of Economy & Tourism. "The time to buy a property in Dubai is now..."

"We are building a stronger, more resilient Dubai..."

On whether crypto payment option will be available, a DLD official said it's up to the 'participating banks'. They include Emirates NBD, Mashreq, Emirates Islamic, Dubai Islamic Bank and Commercial Bank of Dubai. The developers include Emaar, Nakheel, Damac and Azizi, as well as wasl properties, Meraas and Majid Al Futtaim.

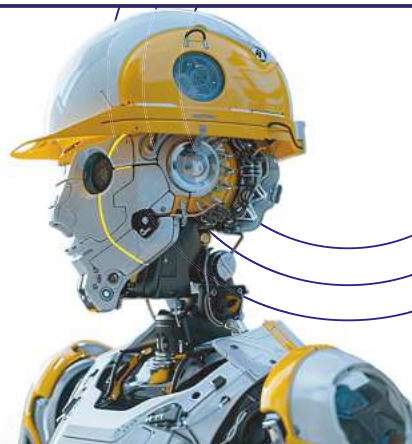


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